

nothing better than Google. It generates highly accurate results in barely a couple of seconds, depending upon your speed. You might also have noticed two more options, 'Cached' and 'Similar Pages'—shown after every search in Google. So if you want sites similar to the one displayed in the result, click 'Similar Pages'.

Yahoo!: Yahoo! has a huge index of sites. So if you are clear on what you are looking for, head for Yahoo! Directory.

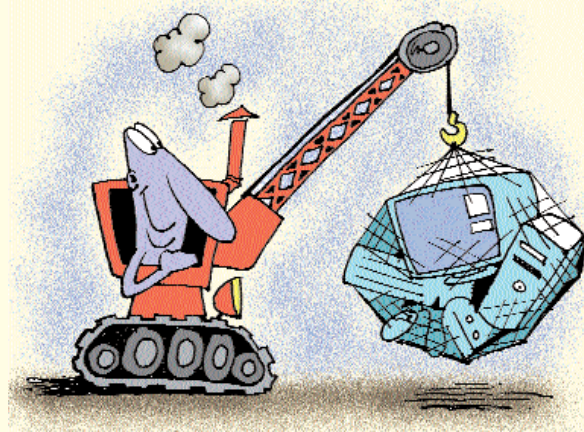
Lycos: The search feature in Lycos filters out inappropriate material by dropping certain keywords from the search criteria. This prevents children from viewing offensive material.



Content filtering in Lycos

AltaVista: AltaVista has a filter option to sift the contents of the search. More importantly, it provides users with a password facility so that the search settings may not be changed. For this, one must first activate the family filter which is present on the home page.

MetaCrawler: MetaCrawler provides a mini crawler that allows you to search from your desktop. If you have a slow connection or are using an old browser, it offers a 'Low bandwidth search'.



DOWNLOAD MANAGERS

■ Dragging and dropping links in FlashGet

Sometimes, after clicking a download link, the browser prompts you to download required files. In order to make your download manager do so automatically, drag and drop the link in the download manager. If you are using FlashGet as your download manager, activate the 'drop zone' option. This will display a small window on your screen; drag and drop the link on to the window and your file will begin downloading.

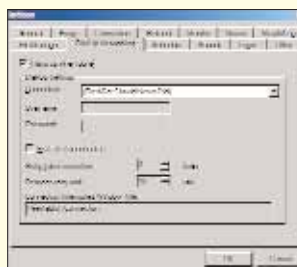
■ Increasing downloads

If your download manager refuses to download more than two or three files at a time, go to Options and change the number of files which are to be downloaded. Usually, by default, download managers allow downloading of two or three files at a time. Increase the limit. Also, you don't have

to wait for the previous file to complete downloading.

■ Specifying speed in FlashGet

If you frequently download multiple files on a network you will end up depriving others of bandwidth. To avoid this, set a speed limit



Time the downloads for efficiency

which restricts the bandwidth utilised by your download manager. For most situations you should set this at about 3 Kbps by going to **Options > Connection > Download Speed Limit**.

■ Scanning downloads

A virus finds ingenious

ways of entering your PC and downloading files without scanning content is an open invitation to PC pestilence. Most download managers give you the option of automatically setting your anti-virus software to scan every file that is downloaded.

In FlashGet you can do this by going to **Tools > Options > File Manager**. Select the 'Use virus scanner to scan the downloaded file(s)' checkbox and then specify the path to your anti-virus software and scan command.

For McAfee AntiVirus this would be something like C:\Program Files\McAfee\VirusScan95\scan95, args /autoscan /nosplash

Norton AntiVirus users might try C:\Program Files\Norton Antivirus\navw32.exe

■ Split files

Splitting files can increase download speeds tremendously in FlashGet. Usually, splitting the file in three or five segments is sufficient. However, if you are downloading a particularly large file which is available from several servers, you could get better speeds by increasing the number of segments being downloaded simultaneously.

The number of segments that you want the file in can be set in the option box that pops up when a download begins. Just set the option for the number of segments that you want the file to be split into. ■

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